

Question:

What is aschizo-affectivedisorder ?

Answer Choices:

- A. A schizo-affective disorder is a term used to describe a personality disorder with features similar to both schizophrenia and affective disorders.
- B. A schizo-affective disorder exclusively involves psychotic symptoms without any mood disturbances.
- C. A schizo-affective disorder is a psychological condition where mood disorders occur as a reaction to schizophrenia treatment.
- D. A schizo-affective disorder is characterized by periods of well-being between episodes of schizophrenia and mood disorders.
- E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.
- F. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of affective disorders.
- G. A schizo-affective disorder is a subtype of schizophrenia.
- H. A schizo-affective disorder develops after the onset of psychosis.
- I. A schizo-affective disorder is a chronic condition with only affective or mood-related symptoms.
- J. A schizo-affective disorder is a mild form of schizophrenia that does not include affective symptoms.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Schizo-affective disorder is a formal DSM-5 psychiatric category in which an individual experiences both major depressive or manic-like mood episodes and at least two of the characteristic psychotic symptoms (delusions, hallucinations, disorganized speech, negative symptoms, catatonia) that persist during the same period. The mood symptoms are necessary for the diagnosis to be made, and they must not occur exclusively during the course of another psychotic disorder like schizophrenia. Option E captures this key criterion: mood symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.

- By contrast:
- B is incorrect because schizo-affective disorder can include both psychotic and mood symptoms; it is not limited to psychosis without mood.
 - A is incorrect because “G” schizo-affective disorder does not describe a personality disorder.
 - C, H: Mood symptoms follow schizophrenia (not schizophrenia as a reaction to treatment or after psychosis); they precede or co-occur.
 - D: Chronic well-being between episodes is characteristic of schizophrenia itself, not schizo-affective disorder.
 - F: Affective disorders are a category distinct from schizo-affective disorder.
 - G: Schizophrenia is a separate category.
 - I: Mood symptoms in schizo-affective disorder do not always persist and are not the sole symptom.

Correct answer: E.

</think>
<answer>
E. A schizo-affective disorder is a combination of schizophrenic and affective disorders, where the affective symptoms must develop before or simultaneously with the psychotic symptoms.
</answer>